

Νουμήνιος ὁ ἐξ Ἀπαμείας

Numenius of Apamea on the Good and Middle Platonism

eul_aid: pyg

Period: Ῥωμαϊκὴ [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Διάλογος [Dialogue](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Numenius of Apamea was a Greek philosopher active in the 2nd century CE during the Roman era. He was a Platonist from the city of Apamea in Syria, working in the period known as Middle Platonism. Beyond this, the specific details of his life and education are not recorded in surviving sources.

His philosophical writings survive only in fragments, quoted by later Neoplatonist and Christian authors. His known works include *On the Good*, *On the Incorruptibility of the Soul*, and *On the Secrets in Plato*, alongside other treatises on topics like numbers and place. He also wrote a dialogue called *The Hoopoe*, and a work *Against the Gnostics* is attributed to him, though the content of these is largely lost.

Numenius is a significant figure for his syncretic approach to philosophy. According to modern scholars, he sought to harmonize the teachings of Plato with those of Pythagoras and engaged with other wisdom traditions. His metaphysical system introduced a hierarchy of divine principles, featuring a supreme First God and a creative Second God responsible for the world. This framework is seen as an important precursor to the later developments of Neoplatonism. His allegorical interpretations and ideas were extensively debated and cited by major later thinkers, including Plotinus, Porphyry, and several early Christian writers.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [On the Good](#) · 2 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- Ἀλβῖνος ὁ Πλατωνικός · [Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης · [Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρίμνηστος · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Ἀττικός · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Κάσσιος Λογγῖνος · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works
- Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός · [Celsus the Platonist](#) · 1 work
- Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς · [Crantor of Soli](#) · 2 works
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · [Heraclides of Pontus](#) · 2 works
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · [Heraclides of Pontus II](#) · 1 work

- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work](#)
- [Ἀνώνυμος Προλεγόμενα εἰς τὴν Πλατωνικὴν Φιλοσοφίαν · Introduction Platonism Anonymous · 1 work](#)